

The History of Artificial Intelligence

Artificial Intelligence (AI) was formally founded as a field in **1956** at the **Dartmouth Conference**, organized by John McCarthy, Marvin Minsky, Nathaniel Rochester, and Claude Shannon. John McCarthy is widely credited as the "**Father of Artificial Intelligence**" and also coined the term itself.

Early AI research in the 1950s and 1960s focused on symbolic reasoning and problem-solving. The first AI program, called **Logic Theorist**, was created by Allen Newell and Herbert Simon in **1955**. It was capable of proving mathematical theorems.

During the **1970s and 1980s**, AI experienced periods known as "**AI Winters**" — times when funding and interest dramatically declined due to unmet expectations. However, the field revived with the rise of **machine learning** in the 1990s.

In **1997**, IBM's **Deep Blue** defeated world chess champion **Garry Kasparov**, marking a major milestone. In **2011**, IBM's **Watson** won the quiz show *Jeopardy!*, beating human champions.

The modern era of AI is dominated by **deep learning**, popularized by Geoffrey Hinton, Yann LeCun, and Yoshua Bengio — collectively known as the "**Godfathers of Deep Learning**" — who won the **Turing Award in 2018**.